SEEIA Connect

A diaspora-led movement for Africa's economic renewal

Securing Economic and Entrepreneurial Initiatives in Africa

1. Who We Are

SEEIA Connect (Securing Economic and Entrepreneurial Initiatives in Africa) is an organisation birthed by African diasporas to educate one another and bring to light the economic challenges and investment opportunities on the continent, and how we can bring about sustainable solutions to drive Africa's economy forward.

We believe the African diaspora carries shared values, capital, skills and networks that, when organised, can be channelled into building a better future for the continent.

At a glance	
Founded by	African diaspora communities
Headquarters	Lagos, Nigeria
Countries of operation	Nigeria, Ghana and Kenya
Focus	Diaspora-led economic and entrepreneurial development
Reach to date	100+ projects supported and 500,000+ people impacted

Mission

To educate and mobilize the African diaspora around the continent's economic challenges and investment opportunities, and to convert that awareness into sustainable, locally anchored development solutions.

Vision

A future in which the African diaspora is a structured, active force in securing Africa's economic and entrepreneurial potential, giving life to the continent's potential one initiative at a time.

Guiding belief

Africa's young population is the key to its sustainable development. Diaspora capital, skill and solidarity, when organized, can be a driving force for that growth.

Our four pillars

- **Business Hub:** a digital gateway connecting diaspora investors with vetted business opportunities, market entry support, and investment-readiness resources.
- **Project Funding & Management:** structuring, funding, and managing human-development projects, from scholarships to skills-acquisition programs.

- **Workforce:** a trusted directory connecting diaspora investors with vetted professionals, artisans, and service providers.
- **Brain Circulation & Early Childhood Education:** channelling diaspora expertise back into the continent and investing in foundational education.

Where we operate

Our headquarters is in Lagos (Oregun, Ikeja). Nigeria is our anchor country for program delivery, farming skills acquisition, and diaspora engagement. Ghana is our West African expansion market for diaspora investment education and business hub services. Kenya is our East African anchor market, extending the network's reach and workforce placement services.

SEEIA Connect was founded by Oladapo Owolabi and is guided by a Board of Trustees and an executive team.

2. Our Flagship Project: SEEIA Empower 1.0

The challenge

African youth face high unemployment and underemployment, driven by a skills mismatch with market demand, limited access to startup capital, and weak links between talent, markets and investment. At the same time, the African diaspora is a significant but under-structured source of capital, expertise and networks.

Our approach

If young people are equipped with market-relevant skills, connected to diaspora networks, supported with access to capital, and integrated into high-growth sectors such as the digital economy, agritech and green industries, they will move into sustainable employment and entrepreneurship. That leads to job creation, higher productivity, and long-term economic growth across Africa.

Three pathways of change

Pathway	How it works	Expected outcome
1. Skills to income	Youth receive market-aligned digital and technical skills, build portfolio-ready competencies, and access freelance, remote or entry-level jobs.	Income generation within 3 to 6 months
2. Skills to enterprise to jobs	High-performing participants receive startup funding and business mentorship, then launch or scale businesses.	Business survival and at least 3 jobs created per startup
3. Diaspora to capital to ecosystem	The diaspora provides funding, mentorship and market access. SEEIA structures this engagement so capital and expertise flow into the local ecosystem.	Increased capital flow and a stronger enterprise ecosystem

Three-year targets (2026 to 2028)

Target	Level
Youth trained	1,500
Startups funded	15
Mentorship sessions	At least 300
Publications and insights per year	At least 3
Youth earning income within 6 months	At least 60%
Startup survival rate after 12 months	At least 70%
Jobs created by funded startups	At least 45
Youth working in high-growth sectors (digital, agritech, green)	At least 50%
Diaspora investment into youth enterprises	Set annually

How it connects to the services below

The services in the next section are the tools that carry this work forward: structured mentorship, skills learning, transparent tracking for donors, and trusted professionals for diaspora projects.

3. How SEEIA Works with the Diaspora

Alongside SEEIA Empower 1.0, SEEIA is developing services that let Africans at home and abroad build, learn and give with confidence and transparency.

3.1 SEEIA Build

Build back home with confidence, wherever you live.

SEEIA Build is a supervised building service for anyone who wants to build in Nigeria, especially Nigerians living abroad. It draws on SEEIA Workforce, our directory of vetted professionals, artisans and service providers. You choose from a pool of architects, engineers, quantity surveyors and builders. A SEEIA project manager supervises the work, you follow progress in the SEEIA app, and payments are tied to verified stages of work. SEEIA is the bridge between you and the professionals.

Why it exists

- Distance makes regular site visits impossible.
- It is hard to know whether a builder is qualified and honest.
- Large upfront payments carry little link to the work actually done.
- Owners rarely see independent evidence of progress or quality.

How it works

1. Create a profile and describe your project: type, location, size, budget range and timeline.
2. Browse the professional pool, including qualifications, registration status and past projects.
3. Choose your preferred professionals. SEEIA does not push any particular one.
4. Agree scope, cost and schedule in a written contract with a payment schedule.
5. A SEEIA project manager is assigned as your point of contact and supervises delivery.
6. The project manager inspects each stage and uploads reports and photos to the app.
7. Payment for each stage is released only after the project manager verifies the work.
8. At handover, the project is inspected, defects are corrected and you receive a handover report and documents.

How your money is protected

Payments follow progress. A typical schedule might look like this, and your contract will set the exact figures:

Stage	Share of contract sum (illustrative)
Mobilisation	20%
Foundation	30%
Structure and roofing	30%
Finishing	15%
Retention, released after the defects-liability period	5%

The long-term aim is to hold funds in escrow with a licensed partner. Escrow means a neutral third party holds the money and releases it only when agreed conditions are met, which protects both owner and builder. SEEIA itself will not hold client funds. During the pilot, owners pay professionals directly, with each payment made only after the project manager has verified the stage.

The professionals you can choose from

Every professional is checked before listing:

- Professional registration confirmed with the relevant regulatory body (for example ARCON for architects, COREN for engineers, QSRBN for quantity surveyors and CORBON for builders).
- Verified identity and business registration.
- A portfolio of completed work and client references.
- A signed SEEIA code of conduct covering quality, honesty, safety and fair dealing.

- Ongoing performance review. Professionals who fall below standard are suspended or removed.

Professional directory:

Name	Profession	Registration No.	Location / specialisation	Status

Fees and transparency

SEEIA charges a service fee of 10% of the contract sum. It is shown clearly before you sign and deducted at each milestone, so nothing is added later. The income funds supervision, the platform, and training for the professionals in the network.

What SEEIA Build does and does not do

- SEEIA supervises and verifies. The professionals you choose carry out the work under your contract.
- SEEIA begins once you have land. Verify title and ownership through an independent lawyer and the land registry before committing funds.
- You and your professionals remain responsible for building permits and approvals. The project manager tracks them.
- No change to scope or cost happens without your written approval.
- If a dispute arises, the project manager reviews first, then mediation. Only the disputed amount is held.

Status

SEEIA Build is a new initiative being introduced in phases: foundation work, a small pilot, then scale.

3.2 Kékòóyè Learning Platform

Kékòóyè means "learning to assimilate": learn practical skills you can use straight away.

Kékòóyè is SEEIA's online learning platform for adults, hosting IT and vocational courses. Learners choose courses taught by experienced instructors. Lessons are short, practical and flexible, so they fit around a job, a business or family life. Each course is built around a clear outcome: what you will be able to do by the final lesson.

Who it is for

- **Working professionals** who want to upskill without leaving their job.

- **Job seekers and career changers** building skills employers need.
- **Entrepreneurs and artisans** growing their craft or business.
- **Instructors and experts** who want to teach and reach learners across Africa and the diaspora.

Course areas

IT and digital skills, vocational and technical skills, and business and creative skills, with more added over time.

What to expect

- Short video lessons you can learn from on a commute or lunch break.
- Practical content with no filler, at your own pace.
- Certificate of completion

Learn in four steps

1. Sign up and create your account.
2. Browse by category and choose a course.
3. Complete short lessons and practical tasks at your own pace.
4. Apply your new skill at work, in business or in your next job.

Become an instructor

Experts can apply to teach. Applications are reviewed, courses are structured into short modules with clear outcomes, and each course is quality-checked before it goes live. Learner feedback then guides updates.

Status

The foundation for hosting courses is in place. Development continues on content creation and integration, the user interface, and accessibility features.

3.3 SEEIA Donor Dashboard

See where your support goes and what it achieves, in real time.

Donors and partners should not have to wait for an annual report to know what their contribution has done. The SEEIA Deliverables Dashboard for Sponsorships, Donations and Grants is a transparent tool that lets grantors and donors track fund allocation, programme outcomes and impact metrics in real time.

Who it is for

- Individual donors, including diaspora supporters.
- Foundations, institutional funders and corporate partners.
- Programme partners and sponsors.

What you can see

- **Funding:** what you contributed, how it was allocated and what has been spent.
- **Progress:** status and milestones for each programme you support.
- **Results:** indicators such as youth trained, startups funded, jobs supported and mentorship sessions held, drawn from the programme results framework.
- **Stories and evidence:** photos, field updates and short case studies.
- **Reports:** downloadable progress reports, receipts and financial summaries.

How it works

1. Register a donor account and verify your details.
2. Choose a programme or fund to support.
3. Contribute through secure payment options.
4. Track the use of funds and progress as updates are posted.
5. Receive periodic reports and share your feedback.

Our commitments

- Accuracy: updates are reviewed by the programme team before posting.
- Timeliness: data is refreshed at least monthly.
- Privacy: donor information is protected and never sold or shared without consent, in line with Nigeria's data protection law.

- Accountability: financial summaries are consistent with SEEIA's accounts4. Our Contribution to the Sustainable Development Goals

SEEIA's work contributes to the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals:

Programme	Goals	How we contribute
SEEIA Empower 1.0	SDG 4, SDG 8, SDG 10, SDG 17	Builds market-relevant skills, supports youth employment and enterprise, widens access to networks and capital, and links the diaspora, local talent and partners.
SEEIA Build	SDG 8, SDG 9, SDG 11, SDG 17	Creates work for skilled professionals, raises construction quality and standards, supports safer, better-built homes and brings diaspora capital into local economies through trusted partnerships.
Kékòóyè Learning Platform	SDG 4, SDG 8, SDG 9, SDG 10	Expands access to technical and vocational skills for adults, builds job and business skills, and uses digital technology to reach people who cannot attend in-person training.

Programme	Goals	How we contribute
Donor Dashboard	SDG 16, SDG 17	Promotes transparent, accountable institutions and strengthens trust and collaboration between SEEIA, donors and partners.

5. How You Can Support

Volunteer, partner, invest or donate there is a place for you whether you live in Lagos, London or Toronto. Choose the way that fits you:

1. Build with us. Register your interest in SEEIA Build and tell us about your project.
2. Give with visibility. Support SEEIA Empower 1.0, the scholarship or the farming skills campaign, and follow your impact on the Donor Dashboard.
3. Invest. Support youth enterprises through SEEIA's funding and incubation pathways.
4. Learn or teach. Take a course on Kékòóyè, or apply to teach what you know.
5. Mentor. Register your interest in mentoring young talent. The SEEIA Mentor-Mentee App is being prepared for launch.
6. Partner with us. Foundations, companies and institutions can co-fund, sponsor or collaborate on programmes.
7. Spread the word. Share this document with your network.

Get in touch

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[Add the registration link or code for the barcode.]

Together, we can build a stronger Africa: one project, one skill and one connection at a time.